

But given the fact that the OSS is freely available to the next person as well, it is easy to conclude that it would not be possible for an arbitrarily high price to sustain. If the price is too high, other vendors will enter the market and sell the same product cheaper. Thus, market forces will ensure that only a fair price is charged.

1.2.3 A Look At Both Types Of Software

1. Longevity

OSS, since it allows modification by all, can survive in its current form for a long time. Users need not worry about the lack of vendor support or feel compelled to upgrade. PS is supported and maintained only by the vendor, so the life of a software is linked to that of its vendor. Commercial organisations, while choosing a PS, cannot consider the performance of the program in isolation: they also have to consider the financial foundations and long-term business viability of the vendor. A user would be left in the lurch if the vendor were to close down in the near future.

2 Quality

Peer review, an excellent mechanism for identifying and resolving shortcomings in a product, can be implemented in OSS since anyone can see the code. The greater the number of people scrutinising the code, the greater the chances of bugs being discovered. In contrast, PS code is usually offered for review only to a select group, so peer review is not as rigorous. The resulting code, therefore is not as bug free as OSS. For example, experts have found that Linux has fewer bugs than Windows. (http://news.com.com/Security+research+suggests+Linux+has+fewer+flaws/2100-1002_3-5489804.html)

3. Portability

While the PC is the dominant computing platform, other computing devices are becoming popular. It is easy for an OSS to be ported to other platforms, since contributors with the relevant expertise can make necessary modifications. A PS vendor's expertise is limited to the platform it is currently serving; porting to other platforms would be influenced by many factors such as profitability.